
Fw: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

From ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>

Date Fri 10/24/2025 2:54 PM

To viewpoints <viewpoints@rcc.edu>

Gabriel Graves

Umoja / Honors / M.E.S.A Student

Lead Fellow - **College Corps**

Intern - **Community Action Leadership Academy (CALA)**

Student Trustee - **Riverside Community College District (RCCD)**



From: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>

Sent: Tuesday, August 19, 2025 2:36 PM

To: Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>; PRES, ASRCC <ASRCC.PRES@rcc.edu>

Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>; VP, ASRCC <ASRCC.VP@rcc.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Thank you, Dr. Cruz-Soto and Dr. Bottoms, I'm open to scheduling this meeting to resolve the issue I have time this week after 2pm.

Gabriel Graves

Umoja / Honors / M.E.S.A Student

Lead Fellow - **College Corps**

Intern - **Community Action Leadership Academy (CALA)**

Student Trustee - **Riverside Community College District (RCCD)**



From: Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>

Sent: Tuesday, August 19, 2025 2:34 PM

To: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>; PRES, ASRCC <ASRCC.PRES@rcc.edu>; Graves, Gabriel <ggraves1@student.rccd.edu>

Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>; VP, ASRCC <ASRCC.VP@rcc.edu>; Carter, FeRita <FeRita.Carter@rcc.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Dear All,

This conversation should be taken offline and communicated in good faith in person. I understand the importance of email and having receipts, but this is not the way we want to represent ourselves as a college or district with our student leaders.

I asked that the faculty coordinators provide moderation and guidance here and that Dr. Bottoms take the lead in bringing this to a resolution that is functional and productive for all involved.

This is the start of the academic year; there is no time for dysfunction.

Happy to assist where appropriate.

-TCS

Thomas A. Cruz-Soto, Jr., Ed.D.
Dean of Student Services – Riverside City College
Charles A. Kane Student Services and Administration Building
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4800 Magnolia Avenue
Riverside, California 92506
(951)222-8073 (Office)
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From: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>

Date: Tuesday, August 19, 2025 at 2:22 PM

To: PRES, ASRCC <ASRCC.PRES@rcc.edu>, Graves, Gabriel <ggraves1@student.rccd.edu>

Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>, Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>, Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>, Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norccollege.edu>, VP, ASRCC <ASRCC.VP@rcc.edu>, Carter, FeRita <FeRita.Carter@rcc.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

While I respect your position and authority in the ASRCC I reject the notion that you speak for the entirety of the body and especially not the Senate who is the body with the authority to deny or approve legislative matters.

I'm doing what I can to establish communication and collaboration with you and the rest of the ASRCCD, but I've encountered more resistance from you in organizing and concentrating our efforts than any other AS across the district.

I respect that you want to prioritize the duties and responsibilities of ASRCC, but that includes considering the needs of the rest of the district. I contacted the Senate team and Secretary for the appropriate documents.

If the committees have yet to be structured, then I'm not sure how the board is making decisions about legislative initiatives. **If you are asking me and the rest of the public to follow the policies laid out**

in your by-laws but not following them yourselves then there is an issue of integrity within the leadership team.

I want to collaborate and be able to address the issues of all the students of the district. I've been nothing but professional, and **I'm asking for documents that should already be published per ASRCC Executive By-laws Chapter 1 & 8 Articles 2 & 1 respectively,**

- "Minutes of the Executive Cabinet and Committees/Councils shall be posted to the website within 72 hours of the meeting conclusion"
- "Agendas should be posted to the website 24 hours in advance of the meeting"

Additionally, as the ASRCC President **you are compelled by the ASRCC Constitution Article 2 Section 6.9 to "Fulfill any duties assigned to them by the RCCD Student Trustee as well as give continual updates regarding RCC activities."**

I want to be able to continue working together with you to without feeling hostility or feeling alienated because everything that I've asked of you is met with resistance and/or rejected. **This is intended to be a democratic and transparent process but when rules and powers are being wielded inequitably, then there becomes integrity issues.**

This will be my warning before I recommend you, and other ASRCC leadership members for disciplinary action for violations of by-laws policy and neglect of duties as outlined by the ASRCC Constitution and respective by-laws policies.

I want to work with you effectively, and I'm positioned to be able to streamline and amplify the efforts of the entire ASRCCD body. **Please, acknowledge and comply with my request for documentation within 72 hours,** so I can ensure that I'm able to support you as well as all of the other constituents that we serve across the district.

Thank you,

Gabriel Graves

Umoja / Honors / M.E.S.A Student

Lead Fellow - **College Corps**

Intern - **Community Action Leadership Academy (CALA)**

Student Trustee - **Riverside Community College District (RCCD)**

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COLLEGE DISTRICT



From: PRES, ASRCC <ASRCC.PRES@rcc.edu>

Sent: Tuesday, August 19, 2025 12:56 PM

To: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>; Graves, Gabriel <ggraves1@student.rccd.edu>

Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>; Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>; VP, ASRCC <ASRCC.VP@rcc.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Hi Trustee Graves,

You're welcome and happy to give feedback anytime ! Thank you for your message and for sharing your concerns. As I've mentioned in our previous meeting, ASRCC does not operate in a vacuum. Our vision is inclusive not only of

Norco and MVC but also of our entire region. The foundation we are laying at RCC is with the understanding that collaboration across our district is essential.

At the same time, I must also reflect the current work and direction of ASRCC. Right now, our government has been focused on getting organized, trained, and situated so that we can operate effectively. Within the last couple of weeks, we have appointed directors and an executive secretary who is now being trained and will be responsible for taking minutes and managing records. For our required summer meetings, I recorded the minutes myself until this transition could take place. Our first Senate meeting is scheduled for September 2, 2025, after the school year resumes. Once our systems are in place, we will be better positioned to address needs beyond the immediate.

Regarding your email, I'm not sure which team you contacted, as I did not receive any messages regarding the minutes.

I also want to note that you are requesting to be added to a legislative agenda, but the first Senate meeting of the year has not yet taken place, and the senators have not had the opportunity to determine committee assignments. It would be greatly appreciated if you would allow us to complete our initial organization so that we can properly assist you with the items you need in the future. While I wish I had the time to provide a step-by-step play of what we are doing daily, time does not permit; however, you will have access to the information you need when it is made available.

As for your resolution, ASRCC has chosen not to sponsor it at this time, as we have developed a resolution that reflects student government priorities. You are well aware of what we were planning because you attended the Senate meeting where I introduced the stipends proposal to the Senate. That said, if you would like to draft a resolution specifically regarding the district providing a direct typing or resource to the Student Trustee, I think that is a very creative idea and worth exploring on your end.

We remain committed to transparency, inclusivity, and collaboration, but also to ensuring that our student government is firmly grounded before taking on additional initiatives.

Kind regards,

Myisha Jackson

President, ASRCC

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From: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>

Sent: Tuesday, August 19, 2025 12:28:59 PM

To: PRES, ASRCC <ASRCC.PRES@rcc.edu>; Graves, Gabriel <ggraves1@student.rccd.edu>

Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>; Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Thank you for your feedback, President Jackson. I'm happy that the ASRCC Senate has been working diligently on this issue, though I want to be sure to remind you that ASRCC doesn't operate in a vacuum.

The students at Norco and MVC also play a role in the student success and enrollment at RCC. There are students who are contributing to ASRCC funds are attending our sister campuses but have designated RCC as their home campus. Furthermore, Norco and MVC are prospering, and help in attracting students into our district — which also adds to the available resources to the RCC campus and population as well.

I appreciate that you are willing to review the documents that I've provided, and I trust that you have the students' best interests at heart. As we continue forward through this year, It will be absolutely essential for my team to organize initiatives across the district. This requires adequate communication, and access to public documents and records. There is a lack of transparency with publishing agendas and minutes within the ASRCC which is leaving us guessing without a way to accurately gauge what ASRCC is doing. Again, thank you for expressing your sentiment of solidarity. I know that as we proceed with the year, I will need to lean on you for support.

I emailed your team this morning requesting the documentation for the actions and meetings that have transpired since the beginning of our terms. Please have them send them to me in a timely manner so I can review them. Also, please include me in your email lists for events and meetings so I can ensure the Student Trustee will have representation and be able to advise you all from the perspective of the interests of our students across the district.

Thank you,

Gabriel Graves

Umoja / Honors / M.E.S.A Student

Lead Fellow - **College Corps**

Intern - **Community Action Leadership Academy (CALA)**

Student Trustee - **Riverside Community College District (RCCD)**

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From: PRES, ASRCC <ASRCC.PRES@rcc.edu>

Sent: Tuesday, August 19, 2025 2:10 AM

To: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>; Graves, Gabriel <ggraves1@student.rccd.edu>

Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>; Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Hello Trustee Graves,

Thank you for sharing your resolution and for the time, research, and dedication you've put into advocating for equitable student participation across our district. Your efforts to highlight the importance of stipends for underrepresented voices are appreciated, and I recognize the value in building a unified approach to strengthen our advocacy at the board level.

At Riverside City College, our Associated Students have already engaged in thorough discussions and reached an agreement on what is viable for our members in terms of time, commitment, and resources. We have developed and proposed a resolution that reflects the needs and circumstances of our campus, and after careful deliberation, we feel this framework works best for us at this time.

That being said, we are open to continued collaboration and conversation as this movement progresses districtwide. We also appreciate your willingness to present your findings, and while our body has already finalized our approach, we will gladly review any supplemental information you provide to ensure that our decisions remain data-informed and considerate of diverse perspectives.

Thank you again for including us in this important conversation.

In solidarity,

Myisha Jackson

President, Associated Students of Riverside City College (ASRCC)

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From: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>

Sent: Monday, August 18, 2025 10:36:10 PM

To: Graves, Gabriel <ggraves1@student.rccd.edu>

Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>; Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>

Subject: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Hello Presidents, I'm aware of the movement in our district to create a more equitable working environment for our Associated Student members.

Thus, I have drafted a resolution to sponsor student stipends to ensure that underrepresented voices can participate without undue financial hardship. Please, bring this resolution to the legislative floor for debate, discussion, and action to ensure that we are unified in our efforts to increase engagement and incentivize student participation. I will include my sources that are cited so that they can also be added to your respective legislating bodies for your campuses.

I hope to be able to educate our leaders and ensure that they can make rational, and data driven decisions. Thus, I would also like to come and present my findings during your meetings. Please provide me with the meeting schedule for your regular (or committee) legislative meetings so that I can attend (or send a representative in my stead).

Again, I realize that there is already momentum growing in support of student representative stipends which is why I want your legislatures to sponsor this resolution. When we show a unified district wide effort, we can garner more support at the board level.

I've also created a survey that our students can use to give their opinions on the matter.

<https://forms.office.com/r/rHJWN4v0GG>

Please help me gather student opinions as we enter into this semester and get started with our business.

Best,

Gabriel Graves

Umoja / Honors / M.E.S.A Student

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